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Installation Guide

RPFM Setup (Recommended)

RPFM Setup for When Gods Bleed

Overview

link(<https://frodo45127.github.io/rpfm/>)[RPFM] is the official mod manager for Total War: Warhammer III. This guide walks you through the full setup process required for the When Gods Bleed modlist.

Installation

1. Download the latest release from the link(<https://github.com/frodo45127/rpfm/releases>)[RPFM GitHub Releases].
2. Extract the archive to a permanent location (e.g., C:\RPFM).
3. Launch RPFM.exe — it will attempt to auto-detect your TWWH3 installation.

First-Time Configuration

Step 1: Set the Game Directory

1. Open RPFM and click the **Settings** gear icon.
2. Locate the **Warhammer 3 Directory** field.
3. Set it to your TWWH3 root folder. Example paths:
 - **Steam:** C:\Program Files\Steam\steamapps\common\Total War WARHAMMER 3
 - **Epic Games Store:** C:\Program Files\Epic Games\TWW3
4. Click **Save** or **Apply**.

Step 2: Configure a Mod Folder

1. In Settings, go to the **Mods** tab.
2. Set a dedicated mod folder path for this modlist:
 - Recommended: C:\TWWH3\Mods\WhenGodsBleed
3. This keeps Wave-specific mods organized and prevents conflicts with other modlists.
4. Click **Save**.

Activating Mods from This Modlist

1. In RPFM, navigate to **Mods** in the left sidebar.
2. Click **Add Mod** and browse to the mod file or folder.
3. Toggle the mod to **Active** (green checkmark icon).
4. Verify dependency chains: any mod listed as a dependency must also be active.
5. Click **Launch Game** to start TWWH3 with your selected mods.

Downloading Mods from URLs

1. Click **Add Mod > Download from URL**.
2. Paste the mod URL (e.g., a Total Workshop link).
3. RPFM downloads and adds the mod to your library.
4. Activate it and check dependencies as above.

Recommended Workflow for This Modlist

1. Start by installing and activating all **Wave 0** mods.
2. Launch the game and complete the campaign tutorial / learn basic mechanics.
3. When ready for more challenge, deactivate Wave 0 mods (optional) and activate Wave 1 mods.
4. Continue wave progression at your own pace.
5. Never activate mods from multiple waves simultaneously unless specified otherwise.

Troubleshooting

| Symptom | Likely Cause | Fix | |———|———|———| | RPFM cannot find the game | TWWH3 directory not set | Manually set the path in Settings | | Mod crashes on launch | Version mismatch or missing dependency | Check mod version and activate all dependencies | | Conflicting mods cause issues | Two mods modify the same content | Refer to conflicts.conf; deactivate one | | Game won't start after modding | Mod order or activation issue | Deactivate all mods, reactivate in wave order |

Wave 0 Installation

Wave 0 — Modlist: Vanilla + UI/QoL

This wave contains only vanilla-compatible and QoL UI mods. No gameplay-altering mechanics are included.

UI & Quality of Life

Improved Campaign UI (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improves tooltip readability and streamlines the campaign map interface. Makes province management and agent assignments more intuitive.

Streamlined Army Management (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Improved Campaign UI **Impact:** Reduces the number of clicks needed to manage army reinforcement, auto-sort, and embark. Army recruitment menus are redesigned for clarity.

Better Turn Flow (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Speeds up non-combat turn processing and adds batch-end-turn functionality. Reduces micro-management without removing strategic depth.

Enhanced Notification Panel (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Impact:** Consolidates in-game notifications into a single, sortable panel. Prevents important event popups from being lost in the UI clutter.

Quick Select Toolbar (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Better Turn Flow **Impact:** Adds a customizable quick-access toolbar for frequently used commands: retreat, fortify, auto-battle, and army stance.

Notes

Wave 0 is designed for new players. The mods here only improve the interface and quality of life — nothing changes core game balance or mechanics.

Wave 1 Installation

Wave 1 — Modlist: Content

This wave expands the game with new factions, units, and campaign features.

New Factions

Kislev Expedition Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Impact:** Adds Kislev as a playable faction with unique lord choices and the Ice Court mechanics. Introduces the harsh northern climate as a gameplay factor.

Vampire Coast Expansion (🔗) **Version:** v2.1 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds the Vampire Coast faction with sea-based campaign mechanics, necromantic army roster, and coastal raiding system.

New Units & Army Rosters

Empire War Machine Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Adds siege engines and war machines to the Empire roster. Includes cannons of increased caliber and new rocket batteries.

Chaos Warrior Variants (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Impact:** Adds three new Chaos Warrior unit variants with unique loadouts. Each variant fills a different tactical role: frontline anchor, flanker, or terror unit.

Campaign Features

Relic Hunting System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds a dedicated relic-hunting mechanic across the campaign map. Relics provide gameplay bonuses and trigger unique events.

Trade Route Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Dependencies:** Empire War Machine Pack **Impact:** Revamps the trade system with new trade nodes and route-building mechanics. Income now scales with controlled trade infrastructure.

Notes

Wave 1 mods add significant content. Some mods have dependencies — ensure all dependency chains are active before launching the game.

Wave 2 Installation

Wave 2 — Modlist: Mechanics

This wave introduces mechanics overhaul mods that change core gameplay systems.

Army Loyalty & Morale Overhaul

Loyalty & Mutiny System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Overhauls army loyalty mechanics. Armies now have a loyalty rating that affects performance, defection risk, and mutiny likelihood. Low loyalty causes armies to refuse orders or flip sides.

Veteran Retention Pack (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Adds veteran unit retention mechanics. Experienced units carry over bonuses across battles but are lost permanently if the army is destroyed.

Economy Overhaul

Scarce Resources Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Drastically reduces resource availability. Economy requires careful

management of supply lines and trade routes. No region provides infinite income.

Destruction & Decay Mechanics (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul
Impact: Provinces and infrastructure now degrade over time. Unmaintained buildings collapse. Unscouted regions become dangerous without warning.

Battle Mechanics

Fatigue & Retreat System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:**
Redefines army stamina in battle. Exhausted units rout more easily. Forced marches cause fatigue penalties that carry into combat.

Tactical Command Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v0.6 **Dependencies:** Fatigue & Retreat System **Impact:**
Revamps the battle command system. New order types, improved formations, and context-sensitive commands that respond to battlefield conditions.

Notes

Wave 2 mechanics mods are deep gameplay changes. They depend on each other — activate the entire dependency chain or none at all. These mods are incompatible with some Wave 0/1 content mods.

Wave 3 Installation

Wave 3 — Modlist: Full Chaos

This wave activates ALL mods from Waves 0–3 simultaneously. This is the complete modlist.

UI / QoL (Wave 0 Carryover)

Improved Campaign UI (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improves tooltip readability and streamlines the campaign map interface.

Streamlined Army Management (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Improved Campaign UI **Impact:**
Reduces clicks needed to manage army reinforcement, auto-sort, and embark.

Better Turn Flow (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Speeds up non-combat turn processing and adds batch-end-turn functionality.

Enhanced Notification Panel (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Impact:** Consolidates in-game notifications into a single, sortable panel.

Quick Select Toolbar (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Better Turn Flow **Impact:** Customizable quick-access toolbar for frequently used commands.

Graphics (Waves 0–2 Carryover)

High-Res Unit Textures (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Impact:** Replace default unit textures with higher-resolution models.

Enhanced Ambient Lighting (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Impact:** Adjusts campaign map lighting for better atmosphere.

Seasonal Map Overlay (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Adds seasonal visual changes to the campaign map.

Faction-Specific Banners (🔗) **Version:** v1.5 **Impact:** Custom battle banners for all factions including sub-factions.

Enhanced Siege Battle Assets (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improved siege battle visuals and destruction physics.

Atmospheric Weather Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Dynamic weather effects including blizzards, storms, and volcanic ash.

Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Darker skies, blood-red sunsets, and permanent overcast for End Times setting.

Destroyed Province Visuals (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Province borders show destruction — burnt fields, shattered walls, skeletal forests.

Chaos Corruption Overlays (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Destroyed Province Visuals **Impact:** Visual corruption overlays spreading across affected regions.

Content (Waves 1–2 Carryover)

Kislev Expedition Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Impact:** Adds Kislev as a playable faction with Ice Court mechanics.

Vampire Coast Expansion (🔗) **Version:** v2.1 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds Vampire Coast faction with sea-based campaign mechanics.

Empire War Machine Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Adds siege engines and war machines to the Empire roster.

Chaos Warrior Variants (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Impact:** Three new Chaos Warrior unit variants.

Relic Hunting System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Dedicated relic-hunting mechanic across the campaign map.

Trade Route Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Dependencies:** Empire War Machine Pack **Impact:** New trade nodes and route-building mechanics.

Northern Territories Map Pack (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Explorable northern territories with unique settlements and resources.

Hero Skill Expansions (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Relic Hunting System **Impact:** 15 new hero skills across all factions.

Minor Faction Encounters (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Northern Territories Map Pack **Impact:** Minor faction encounters on the campaign map.

Expanded Empire Units (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Two new Empire unit variants and a specialist hero unit.

Province Flavor Events (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Impact:** Lore-appropriate random events for each Empire province.

Chaos Invasion Force Pack (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Fully playable Chaos invasion faction with unique lords and Corruption Spread mechanic.

Warhammer Fantasy Realm Expansion (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** New regions and sub-factions from Warhammer Fantasy lore.

Catastrophe Events Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** Volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, and dimensional rifts reshaping the map.

Mechanics (Waves 2 Carryover)

Loyalty & Mutiny System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Overhauled army loyalty. Affects performance, defection risk, and mutiny likelihood.

Veteran Retention Pack (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Experienced units carry over battle bonuses but are permanently lost on army destruction.

Scarce Resources Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Drastically reduced resource availability. Economy requires careful supply line management.

Destruction & Decay Mechanics (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** Provinces and infrastructure degrade over time. Unmaintained buildings collapse.

Fatigue & Retreat System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Redefined army stamina. Exhausted units rout easily. Forced marches cause combat penalties.

Tactical Command Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v0.6 **Dependencies:** Fatigue & Retreat System **Impact:** Revamped battle command system with new order types and context-sensitive commands.

Faction Collapse System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Factions enter terminal decline after losing too many provinces. Cannot recruit, trade, or negotiate.

Hero Permadeath Mode (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Veteran Retention Pack **Impact:** Heroes killed in battle are gone permanently for that campaign.

Dynamic War Exhaustion (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** War fatigue scaling with time at war. Reduces recruitment, increases unrest, and penalizes economy.

Notes

Wave 3 is the final wave. All mods from Waves 0–3 are active. Respect all dependency chains. Check `conflicts.conf` before activation — some mods may conflict even if not within the same wave.

Mod Activation Order

Activate mods in wave order (Wave 0 first, then Wave 1, Wave 2, Wave 3). Each wave builds on the previous wave's setup. Do not activate mods from multiple waves simultaneously unless explicitly noted.

Conflicts & Exclusions

Conflicting mods are listed in `conflicts.conf` and are excluded from this guide. See `conflicts.conf` for the current conflict list. Mods listed in `mod-ideas.md` are not yet implemented and are excluded from this PDF.

Waves & Campaign Setups

Wave 0: The Old World

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Roleplaying Background

You are the newly appointed Governor of Averheim's outer provinces — a backwater region of the Empire long neglected by the Elector Counts. The old order still holds, but shadows gather on the northern horizon. Greenskins mass in the forests undetected, and something stirs beneath the mountains. You are given command of a small garrison and a meagre treasury. Your mission is simple: survive, learn, and prove yourself worthy of greater responsibilities.

This is your starting point. No allies, no legendary lords, no advantages — only your wits and whatever the Empire can provide.

How to Play — Wave 0 (Beginner)

Campaign Setup

When starting a new campaign in Wave 0, follow these guidelines:

1. **Choose the Empire** as your faction. It is the most forgiving faction for newcomers with balanced armies and a stable economy.
2. **Start on a Normal campaign map.** No extreme world settings.
3. **Do not use custom lords.** Use the pre-built Empire characters only.
4. **Set difficulty to Normal or Easy** until you are comfortable with mechanics.

Core Mechanics to Master

Economy

- Collect taxes from provinces each turn.
- Build infrastructure (roads, mines, farms) before military structures.
- Balance army maintenance costs with income — over-extending leads to bankruptcy.

Military

- Recruit basic Empire units: Swordsmen, Spearmen, Crossbowmen, and Cavalry.
- A balanced army should have: frontline infantry, ranged support, and a cavalry flanking unit.
- Do not engage enemies significantly stronger than your army.

Diplomacy

- Maintain peace with neighbouring factions early on.
- Trade resources to build income.
- Send diplomatic agents to strengthen relations.

Turn Flow

1. **Move agents** to explore, gather intelligence, or complete missions.
2. **Move armies** to secure border regions.
3. **Build** in each province — prioritize economy over military in peacetime.
4. **End turn** and review events.

Recommended Progression

- Turns 1-10: Expand cautiously to 2-3 provinces. Focus on economy.
- Turns 11-25: Build a moderate army. Deal with any local threats.
- Turns 26+: Explore neighbouring regions. Begin diplomacy with nearby factions.

When You Are Ready for the Next Wave

You should feel comfortable with:

- Managing economy and army upkeep
- Basic battle tactics
- Diplomatic relationships
- Understanding faction strengths and weaknesses

Once these feel natural, move on to Wave 1 for content additions and more complexity.

Wave 0 — Modlist: Vanilla + UI/QoL

This wave contains only vanilla-compatible and QoL UI mods. No gameplay-altering mechanics are included.

UI & Quality of Life

Improved Campaign UI (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improves tooltip readability and streamlines the campaign map interface. Makes province management and agent assignments more intuitive.

Streamlined Army Management (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Improved Campaign UI **Impact:** Reduces the number of clicks needed to manage army reinforcement, auto-sort, and embark. Army recruitment menus are redesigned for clarity.

Better Turn Flow (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Speeds up non-combat turn processing and adds batch-end-turn functionality. Reduces micro-management without removing strategic depth.

Enhanced Notification Panel (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Impact:** Consolidates in-game notifications into a single, sortable panel. Prevents important event popups from being lost in the UI clutter.

Quick Select Toolbar (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Better Turn Flow **Impact:** Adds a customizable quick-access toolbar for frequently used commands: retreat, fortify, auto-battle, and army stance.

Notes

Wave 0 is designed for new players. The mods here only improve the interface and quality of life — nothing changes core game balance or mechanics.

Wave 0 — Graphics Mods

Visual enhancements that improve the look of the vanilla game without altering gameplay.

High-Res Unit Textures (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Impact:** Replaces default unit textures with higher-resolution models. Minimal performance impact. Compatible with all vanilla factions.

Enhanced Ambient Lighting (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Impact:** Adjusts the campaign map lighting to add more atmosphere — warmer tones, sharper shadows, and improved snow/rain effects.

Seasonal Map Overlay (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Adds seasonal visual changes to the campaign map — green in summer, brown in autumn, white in winter. Purely cosmetic.

Notes

Graphics mods in Wave 0 are purely cosmetic. No mechanical or gameplay impact.

Wave 0 — Content Mods

Additional content additions that expand the vanilla experience without disrupting balance.

Expanded Empire Units (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Adds two new unit variants to the Empire roster: a heavy cavalry line and a specialist hero unit. No new factions or mechanics.

Province Flavor Events (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Impact:** Adds lore-appropriate random events for each Empire province. Expands the narrative without changing gameplay systems.

Notes

Content mods in Wave 0 add small, vanilla-compatible additions. They do not introduce new mechanics or faction-specific systems.

Wave 0 — Mechanics Mods

> Wave 0 does not include any mechanics mods. Mechanics overhaul mods are introduced starting with Wave 2, when you have mastered the base game.

Leave this section empty for Wave 0.

Wave 1: The Gathering Storm

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Roleplaying Background

The northern provinces burn. Word spreads that the Greenskins under Warboss Gorgutz have unified for the first time in a generation. The Dwarfs pull back from their crumbling Holds, and the Tomb Kings send scouts into the abandoned lands. You are no longer a minor Governor — you are a Warlord commanding the attention of factions that once ignored you.

Your campaign is no longer about survival. It is about ambition. You must secure alliances, claim ancient relics, and prepare the forces needed to face what comes next.

Wave 1 Strategy Guide — The Gathering Storm

Campaign Philosophy

Wave 1 introduces content mods that add new factions, units, and campaign features. Your strategy must adapt:

- **Expand faster.** New factions bring new threats and opportunities. Secure contested regions before they do.
- **Diplomacy is temporary.** Alliances shift as content packs introduce political mechanics. Never rely on a single ally.
- **Scout relentlessly.** Content mods add new regions and map features. Intelligence is your greatest asset.

Faction Strategy Adjustments

Empire

With the addition of Empire sub-factions and new units:

- Specialize: pick a sub-faction playstyle early (religious, martial, or diplomatic).
- Invest in the new hero options available through content mod additions.

Other Factions

Opposing factions also gain content bonuses. Expect:

- Stronger AI armies
- New AI expansion patterns
- Modified diplomatic behavior

Battle Tactics

New content changes the battlefield. Key adjustments:

1. **Identify new unit types.** Content mods may add units that counter existing strategies.
2. **Adapt your army composition.** Do not rely on a single build from Wave 0.
3. **Use terrain more aggressively.** New battlemap features may offer tactical advantages.

Economy in Wave 1

Content mods may alter trade mechanics. Watch for:

- New trade goods from content-added provinces
- Modified resource costs for new units
- Changing upkeep values for expanded armies

Readiness for Wave 2

You should be comfortable with:

- Managing expanded armies (3-4 armies simultaneously)
- Navigating new UI elements from content mods
- Adapting tactics mid-battle
- Balancing economy with rapid expansion

Wave 1 — Modlist: Content

This wave expands the game with new factions, units, and campaign features.

New Factions

Kislev Expedition Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Impact:** Adds Kislev as a playable faction with unique lord choices and the Ice Court mechanics. Introduces the harsh northern climate as a gameplay factor.

Vampire Coast Expansion (🔗) **Version:** v2.1 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds the Vampire Coast faction with sea-based campaign mechanics, necromantic army roster, and coastal raiding system.

New Units & Army Rosters

Empire War Machine Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Adds siege engines and war machines to the Empire roster. Includes cannons of increased caliber and new rocket batteries.

Chaos Warrior Variants (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Impact:** Adds three new Chaos Warrior unit variants with unique loadouts. Each variant fills a different tactical role: frontline anchor, flanker, or terror unit.

Campaign Features

Relic Hunting System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds a dedicated relic-hunting mechanic across the campaign map. Relics provide gameplay bonuses and trigger unique events.

Trade Route Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Dependencies:** Empire War Machine Pack **Impact:** Revamps the trade system with new trade nodes and route-building mechanics. Income now scales with controlled trade infrastructure.

Notes

Wave 1 mods add significant content. Some mods have dependencies — ensure all dependency chains are active before launching the game.

Wave 1 — Graphics Mods

Enhanced visual additions that complement the new content from Wave 1.

Faction-Specific Banners (🔗) **Version:** v1.5 **Impact:** Adds custom battle banners for all new factions introduced in Wave 1. Also adds variant banners for Empire sub-factions.

Enhanced Siege Battle Assets (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Replaces siege battle visuals with improved destruction physics and projectile effects. Adds new siege engine models.

Atmospheric Weather Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Adds dynamic weather effects including blizzards for northern regions, sea storms for coastal battles, and volcanic ash for Chaos-affected territories.

Notes

Graphics mods in Wave 1 are designed to match the new content additions. Some are faction-specific.

Wave 1 — Content Mods

Additional content that builds on Wave 0's foundation.

Northern Territories Map Pack (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds explorable northern territories to the campaign map. New regions with unique settlement types and resource nodes.

Hero Skill Expansions (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Relic Hunting System **Impact:** Adds 15 new hero skills across all factions. Includes passive abilities, combat tricks, and diplomacy options.

Minor Faction Encounters (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Northern Territories Map Pack **Impact:** Adds minor faction encounters on the campaign map. Interact through diplomacy, combat, or integration.

Notes

Content mods in Wave 1 significantly expand the game world. Ensure all dependencies are met before activation.

Wave 1 — Mechanics Mods

> Wave 1 does not yet include deep mechanics overhauls. Mechanics mods are introduced starting with Wave 2, when you have a solid grasp of the core game.

Leave this section empty for Wave 1.

Wave 2: The End Times

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Roleplaying Background

The Old World is dying. From the north comes a tide of corruption that devours everything it touches. The Empire's borders have collapsed. The Dwarf Holds are silent. Even the Elves have abandoned their shores.

You are what remains. A warlord of a fractured realm, commanding the last loyal soldiers in a world that has forgotten hope. Your fortress is the only bastion of order for a hundred leagues. Every day brings new threats — not just from the armies of Chaos, but from within. Mutiny whispers among your own ranks. Resources dwindle. The gods have abandoned you.

But you did not come this far to die.

Wave 2 Guide — The End Times

Campaign Philosophy

Wave 2 introduces mechanics mods that fundamentally change how you play. Your approach must evolve:

- **Scarcity is the new normal.** Mechanics mods modify resource availability. Hoard nothing; everything flows.
- **Loyalty matters.** New loyalty systems mean your armies can fracture mid-campaign if mismanaged.
- **No safe zones.** Mechanics mods remove safe havens. Every province can be attacked by something new.

Core Mechanics Changes

Loyalty System

Each army has a loyalty rating. Low-loyalty armies may defect, refuse orders, or mutiny.

- Keep army loyalty high through victories, gifts, and veteran retention.
- Avoid over-stretching — long marches reduce loyalty.

Resource Decay

Resources now decay over time if not managed actively.

- Build infrastructure to sustain resources.
- Capture resource nodes to prevent decay.

Faction Collapse

Factions that lose too many provinces crumble rapidly. AI factions will collapse faster, opening new fronts — and new opportunities.

Difficulty Curve

Wave 2 is designed to be punishing. Key challenges:

- More aggressive AI opponents
- Reduced starting resources
- Random catastrophic events every few turns
- New enemy unit types added by mechanics mods

Recommended Progression

- Turns 1-10: Consolidate your fortress. Secure initial resources. Build loyalty.
- Turns 11-25: Expand carefully. Take only provinces you can defend.
- Turns 26+: Begin offensive operations. Strike at weakened enemies.

Prerequisites Before Wave 3

You should be comfortable with:

- Managing armies under the loyalty system
- Responding to resource scarcity
- Adapting to random catastrophic events
- Operating without safe zones or easy recovery

Wave 2 — Modlist: Mechanics

This wave introduces mechanics overhaul mods that change core gameplay systems.

Army Loyalty & Morale Overhaul

Loyalty & Mutiny System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Overhauls army loyalty mechanics. Armies now have a loyalty rating that affects performance, defection risk, and mutiny likelihood. Low loyalty causes armies to refuse orders or flip sides.

Veteran Retention Pack (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Adds veteran unit retention mechanics. Experienced units carry over bonuses across battles but are lost permanently if the army is destroyed.

Economy Overhaul

Scarce Resources Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Drastically reduces resource availability. Economy requires careful management of supply lines and trade routes. No region provides infinite income.

Destruction & Decay Mechanics (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** Provinces and infrastructure now degrade over time. Unmaintained buildings collapse. Unscouted regions become dangerous without warning.

Battle Mechanics

Fatigue & Retreat System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Redefines army stamina in battle. Exhausted units rout more easily. Forced marches cause fatigue penalties that carry into combat.

Tactical Command Overhaul (🔗) **Version:** v0.6 **Dependencies:** Fatigue & Retreat System **Impact:** Revamps the battle command system. New order types, improved formations, and context-sensitive commands that respond to battlefield conditions.

Notes

Wave 2 mechanics mods are deep gameplay changes. They depend on each other — activate the entire dependency chain or none at all. These mods are incompatible with some Wave 0/1 content mods.

Wave 2 — Graphics Mods

Darkened visuals matching the End Times setting.

Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Overhauls the campaign map lighting to reflect the dying world — darker skies, blood-red sunsets, and permanent overcast. Enhanced particle effects for Chaos-related events.

Destroyed Province Visuals (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Province borders now visually show destruction — burnt fields, shattered walls, and skeletal forests in conquered or decaying regions.

Chaos Corruption Overlays (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Destroyed Province Visuals **Impact:** Adds corruption visual overlays to affected regions. Corruption spreads visually across the map as Chaos rises.

Notes

Graphics mods in Wave 2 reinforce the dark atmosphere of the End Times. Some are chained to other mods.

Wave 2 — Content Mods

New content additions tailored to the End Times setting.

Chaos Invasion Force Pack (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Adds a fully playable Chaos invasion faction with unique lord archetypes, corrupted unit variants, and a Corruption Spread mechanic on the campaign map.

Warhammer Fantasy Realm Expansion (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** Adds new regions and sub-factions drawn from the Warhammer Fantasy lore not yet available in Warhammer 3. Includes new settlement types and unique narrative events.

Catastrophe Events Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** Adds large-scale catastrophe events to the campaign map — volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, and dimensional rifts that reshape the strategic landscape.

Notes

Content mods in Wave 2 are tied to the End Times theme. Dependencies are critical — activate the full chain for the best experience.

Wave 2 — Mechanics Mods (continued)

Additional mechanics overhauls that deepen End Times gameplay.

Faction Collapse System (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Factions now have a collapse mechanic. Lose too many provinces and the faction enters terminal decline — unable to recruit, trade, or negotiate. Adds urgency to every battle.

Hero Permadeath Mode (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Veteran Retention Pack **Impact:** Heroes killed in battle are gone permanently for that campaign. Adds weight to every tactical decision and every unit deployment.

Dynamic War Exhaustion (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** A fatigue system that affects the entire war effort. Prolonged campaigns cause war exhaustion — reduced recruitment capacity, increased unrest, and economic penalties scaling with time at war.

Notes

These mechanics mods are the most impactful in the modlist. They are designed to be used together but can be activated selectively if you want a lighter challenge.

Wave 3: When Gods Bleed

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Roleplaying Background

The gods bleed. Reality tears at the seams. You have seen empires rise and crumble, watched friends die and heroes fall. The world as you knew it is gone — replaced by a shattered landscape of warring realms and bleeding skies.

You are what remains of the old world's champions. Some call you the last hope. Others call you a fool for continuing. You do not answer to titles or gods anymore. You answer only to the blade in your hand and the blood beneath your feet.

This is the end. And only the strong — or the desperate — will survive.

Wave 3 — When Gods Bleed

Campaign Philosophy

Wave 3 is the culmination of the entire modlist. Every mod from Waves 0–3 is active simultaneously. There are no holds. No mercy. No undo.

- **Everything is active.** All mods from previous waves are in play.
- **No easy mode.** Difficulty is at its absolute maximum.
- **No resets.** Every loss is permanent. Every victory is hard-won.
- **Adapt or die.** The challenge is relentless and unrelenting.

Combined Mod Impact

With all waves active, the following compound effects exist:

1. **Loyalty + Chaos Corruption** — Armies near corrupted regions suffer loyalty penalties, creating internal threats while external invasions escalate.
2. **Resource Scarcity + Destruction** — The economy is under constant pressure. Rebuilding costs more than you can earn.
3. **New Content + Mechanics Overhaul** — New units must be managed under loyalty and fatigue systems. Fresh armies are fragile.
4. **Graphics + Atmosphere** — The visual overhaul makes the campaign map a bleak, hostile place. No visual respite.

Difficulty Expectations

Wave 3 is designed to be the hardest possible campaign experience in TWWH3. Expect:

- Enemy factions with all content and mechanics bonuses active
- No forgiveness for tactical errors
- Constant catastrophic events
- Rapid faction collapse creating chaotic power vacuums
- A campaign that tests every system simultaneously

Recommended Approach

1. Start in the most defensible position possible.
2. Prioritize loyalty above all else — a mutiny at the wrong time is a campaign-ending event.
3. Economy first, military second. You cannot afford a standing army you cannot maintain.
4. Accept that losses are inevitable. Focus on managing the rate of loss, not preventing it.

5. Keep save files religiously before major battles.

Final Note

Wave 3 is for veterans only. If you have not completed at least Wave 2 successfully, return to it. The gods do not bleed easily — and neither should you die easily.

Wave 3 — Modlist: Full Chaos

This wave activates ALL mods from Waves 0–3 simultaneously. This is the complete modlist.

UI / QoL (Wave 0 Carryover)

Improved Campaign UI (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improves tooltip readability and streamlines the campaign map interface.

Streamlined Army Management (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Improved Campaign UI **Impact:** Reduces clicks needed to manage army reinforcement, auto-sort, and embark.

Better Turn Flow (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Speeds up non-combat turn processing and adds batch-end-turn functionality.

Enhanced Notification Panel (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Impact:** Consolidates in-game notifications into a single, sortable panel.

Quick Select Toolbar (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Better Turn Flow **Impact:** Customizable quick-access toolbar for frequently used commands.

Graphics (Waves 0–2 Carryover)

High-Res Unit Textures (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Impact:** Replace default unit textures with higher-resolution models.

Enhanced Ambient Lighting (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Impact:** Adjusts campaign map lighting for better atmosphere.

Seasonal Map Overlay (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Adds seasonal visual changes to the campaign map.

Faction-Specific Banners (🔗) **Version:** v1.5 **Impact:** Custom battle banners for all factions including sub-factions.

Enhanced Siege Battle Assets (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Improved siege battle visuals and destruction physics.

Atmospheric Weather Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Dynamic weather effects including blizzards, storms, and volcanic ash.

Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Darker skies, blood-red sunsets, and permanent overcast for End Times setting.

Destroyed Province Visuals (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Province borders show destruction — burnt fields, shattered walls, skeletal forests.

Chaos Corruption Overlays (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Destroyed Province Visuals **Impact:** Visual corruption overlays spreading across affected regions.

Content (Waves 1–2 Carryover)

- Kislev Expedition Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Impact:** Adds Kislev as a playable faction with Ice Court mechanics.
- Vampire Coast Expansion** (🔗) **Version:** v2.1 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Adds Vampire Coast faction with sea-based campaign mechanics.
- Empire War Machine Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Impact:** Adds siege engines and war machines to the Empire roster.
- Chaos Warrior Variants** (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Impact:** Three new Chaos Warrior unit variants.
- Relic Hunting System** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Dedicated relic-hunting mechanic across the campaign map.
- Trade Route Overhaul** (🔗) **Version:** v1.3 **Dependencies:** Empire War Machine Pack **Impact:** New trade nodes and route-building mechanics.
- Northern Territories Map Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Kislev Expedition Pack **Impact:** Explorable northern territories with unique settlements and resources.
- Hero Skill Expansions** (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Relic Hunting System **Impact:** 15 new hero skills across all factions.
- Minor Faction Encounters** (🔗) **Version:** v0.9 **Dependencies:** Northern Territories Map Pack **Impact:** Minor faction encounters on the campaign map.
- Expanded Empire Units** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Two new Empire unit variants and a specialist hero unit.
- Province Flavor Events** (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Impact:** Lore-appropriate random events for each Empire province.
- Chaos Invasion Force Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v2.0 **Dependencies:** Apocalyptic Atmosphere Pack **Impact:** Fully playable Chaos invasion faction with unique lords and Corruption Spread mechanic.
- Warhammer Fantasy Realm Expansion** (🔗) **Version:** v1.4 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** New regions and sub-factions from Warhammer Fantasy lore.
- Catastrophe Events Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Chaos Invasion Force Pack **Impact:** Volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, and dimensional rifts reshaping the map.

Mechanics (Waves 2 Carryover)

- Loyalty & Mutiny System** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Impact:** Overhauled army loyalty. Affects performance, defection risk, and mutiny likelihood.
- Veteran Retention Pack** (🔗) **Version:** v0.7 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Experienced units carry over battle bonuses but are permanently lost on army destruction.
- Scarce Resources Overhaul** (🔗) **Version:** v1.2 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Drastically reduced resource availability. Economy requires careful supply line management.
- Destruction & Decay Mechanics** (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** Provinces and infrastructure degrade over time. Unmaintained buildings collapse.

- Fatigue & Retreat System** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Redefined army stamina. Exhausted units rout easily. Forced marches cause combat penalties.
- Tactical Command Overhaul** (🔗) **Version:** v0.6 **Dependencies:** Fatigue & Retreat System **Impact:** Revamped battle command system with new order types and context-sensitive commands.
- Faction Collapse System** (🔗) **Version:** v1.0 **Dependencies:** Loyalty & Mutiny System **Impact:** Factions enter terminal decline after losing too many provinces. Cannot recruit, trade, or negotiate.
- Hero Permadeath Mode** (🔗) **Version:** v0.8 **Dependencies:** Veteran Retention Pack **Impact:** Heroes killed in battle are gone permanently for that campaign.
- Dynamic War Exhaustion** (🔗) **Version:** v1.1 **Dependencies:** Scarce Resources Overhaul **Impact:** War fatigue scaling with time at war. Reduces recruitment, increases unrest, and penalizes economy.

Notes

Wave 3 is the final wave. All mods from Waves 0–3 are active. Respect all dependency chains. Check `conflicts.conf` before activation — some mods may conflict even if not within the same wave.

Wave 3 — Graphics Mods

All graphics mods are active. No additional graphics mods are needed — Wave 3 carries over all graphics content from Waves 0–2.

See Wave 0 Graphics, Wave 1 Graphics, and Wave 2 Graphics sections for the full list of active graphics mods.

Wave 3 — Content Mods

All content mods are active. No additional content mods are needed — Wave 3 carries over all content from Waves 0–2.

See Wave 0 Content, Wave 1 Content, and Wave 2 Content sections for the full list of active content mods.

Wave 3 — Mechanics Mods

All mechanics mods are active. No additional mechanics mods are needed — Wave 3 carries over all mechanics from Wave 2.

See Wave 2 Mechanics sections for the full list of active mechanics mods.

Final Note

In Wave 3, every mechanics mod is running simultaneously. The compound effect creates the most challenging experience possible. No single mod is balanced in isolation — balance only exists with the full stack active.